

Age After War - Lore Summary

*A World Reference Document
February 2026*

Age After War -- World Lore Summary

Quick Reference

The World at a Glance

Year 847. The Last World War ended 847 years ago when the Holy Empire activated a weapon called Heaven's Atlas and destroyed the elven homeland of Calidar in a single afternoon. What followed was five centuries of imperial consolidation, a magic ban enforced by dedicated hunters, and the slow administrative absorption of every race that survived the war. Eight races share one continent under one dominant power. None of them chose this arrangement. A wound in the earth near the imperial capital -- the Rift -- has been growing since Year 0, and what began as a classified geological note is now the defining political crisis of the age.

Timeline

Era	Date	Event	Significance
Pre-war	Y-5000+	Lizardfolk migrate from Subterranean Seas to desert	Establishes first surface civilizations; Hidden River
Pre-war	Y-4000+	Surface Calidar reaches its height	Empire begins; river archives, continent-scale magical scholarship; millions of elves
Pre-war	Y-3000+	Gnomish Collective forms on eastern islands	Automaton technology as labor solution; collective ownership develops
Pre-war	Y-2000+	Dwarven holds deepen into the mountains	Deep cynicism occurs: some dwarves refuse to surface, descend to hollow earth,
Pre-war	Y-1500	Orc clans begin consolidation	First great roads to the Khanate legal code; philosophical groundwork laid
Pre-war	Y-1000	Human kingdoms fracture across central continent	Helios worship consolidates from one of several sun cults into dominant human religion
First Confluence	Y-800 to Y-600	Unknown civilization collapses in the western ocean region	Cities fall into flooded ruins; structural instability created in the boundary between the world's surface and what is b

Pre-war	Y-600	Catastrophic volcanic event reshapes the western archipelago	Ashen Archipelago partially formed; earliest goblin diaspora patterns emerge
Last World War	Y-500	Escalating conflict reaches continental scale	Multiple factions begin to destabilize under the load
Last World War	Y-200	The Great Khan unifies the Orc Clans	Most effective military force the world has seen; Khanate reshapes borders across the
Last World War	Y-100	War's southern theater engulfs Calidar approaches	Western continent fighting for existence
Last World War	Y-50	Heaven's Atlas found and developed	The artifact appears to have been found or extracted rather than built; lizardfolk Astronomy Sect observes unusual energy
Last World War	Y-45	The Great Khan dies in campaign	Cause disputed; Khanate begins to fragment; the most effective military force in history becomes a collection of grievin
Year 0	Year 0	Heaven's Atlas deployed; Calidar destroyed; war ends	Calidar's forests vitrify; rivers boil; stone melts to glass; 80-90% of elves die; Atlas activation tears the pre-existi
Early Age After War	Year 1	Imperial magic ban declared; Luminary Inquest founded; Veiled Hand founded	Elven integration begins through compliance, not choice; lizardfolk Astronomy Sect founds the Veiled Hand in the same ye
Early Age After War	Years 1-50	Elven survivors resettled in planned districts	Calidar sealed; return forbidden; integration bureaucracy (elven-run)
Early Age After War	Years 20-80	Shadow Fen Commune established	Refugees arrive in first of dozens of sanctuaries; infernal pacts negotiated; the Veil
Early Age After War	Year 47	First cross-faction agreement at the Pact Stones	Begins to form Fen Commune, Goblin Resistance cells, and lizardfolk trade sects meet; the seventh stone is already
Early Age After War	Year 75	First imperial survey notes proto-Rift	Cartographers note "a gap in the ground that goes further than it should, emitting periodically a temperature differenti

Middle Period	Year 120	Gnomish withdrawal begins	Production councils' internal assessment: Holy Dominion is a terminal failure state; recommended posture is
Middle Period	Year 250	Seren Vaelas names the Rift	
			Distance and documents the anomaly in full; titles it "On the Possibility of a Permanent Structural Wound"; names it
Middle Period	Year 320	First confirmed Veiled Hand operation	Seven officials across four provinces, all with expanding authority over magical enforcement, die within eighteen months
Middle Period	Year 400	Orc reunion attempt suppressed	
			Six clans gather for the first time since the Khan's death; empire deploys three legions within two weeks; four elders d
Late Period	Year 450	Cathedral District wound becomes visible	Certain shadows fall wrong; children born in the district are statistically more likely to manifest unsanctioned magical
Late Period	Year 480	Gnomish Survey Station 3 established	
			Frost Harbor station authorized for one specific mission: detect Heaven's Atlas-scale energetic signatures; the gnomes a
LOVEGAME Present	Year 500	LOVEGAME setting	The wound is larger than Year 75; lizardfolk sects alarmed; gnomes watching; the Veiled Hand active; the empire
Between the Games	Year 503	First above-ground Rift manifestation	
			Believes corridor appears in a Cathedral District street for four seconds; two witnesses; neither is believed
Between the Games	Year 547	First Compact (six races)	First formal multi-race cooperation regarding the wound; prompted by a Bleed event that floods three blocks with water f

Between the Games	Year 600	Adventure Guild founded	Built on the Veiled Hand's organizational model; public-facing containment and documentation authority; the name Rift co
Between the Games	Year 625	Second Compact (all eight races)	All eight racial governments formally recognize the Rift as a cross-racial concern; goblins sign on condition their sign
Between the Games	Year 750	Warden Grell begins her career	Over the next 97 years she becomes the Guild's most significant historical figure, not because she descends farthest but
Between the Games	Year 800	First unexplainable Rift floor	The Rift produces a floor that responds to the people who enter it; Grell documents: "The floor knows we are here. This
MMOLite Present	Year 847	First Bleed; Rift Compact	Simultaneous Bleed events across multiple racial territories; Adventure Guild calls emergency session; Rift Compact form

The Eight Races

Humans (The Holy Dominion).

Population approximately 1.5 million. Governed by a theocratic empire built around the worship of Helios and the Doctrine of the Chosen, which holds that humans are the rightful administrators of all other races. Lifespan 70-90 years. The Dominion controls the central plains, the largest agricultural territory, and the majority of the continent's infrastructure. Humans cycle through institutional memory every two or three generations, which means the empire is perpetually administered by people who were not there for the things they are repeating. Dominant by elimination rather than by virtue -- the Last World War left them standing because they used a weapon no one else had.

Elves (The Administration).

Population approximately 500,000. Governed through a bureaucratic caste integrated into the imperial administration -- junior partners who process the documents that define every other race's existence. Standard lifespan 500-800 years; a

separate tier called the Ancient Ones lives 10,000 years or more and remembers civilizations the empire has no record of. The Ancient Ones are never playable, never held in imperial positions, and speak about Calidar in the present tense. Ordinary elves serve the empire because survival requires it and because their precision with records gives them leverage no other race has. They know where the locks are. They know which keys are missing.

Orcs (The Clans).

Population approximately 240,000. No unified government since the Great Khan died 847 years ago. The Khanate's fragmentation into nomadic clan confederations is the defining political fact of orcish life. Lifespan 300-500 years, which means thousands of orcs alive today personally served under the Great Khan. They remember. The empire suppresses every attempt at reunion not because the clans would necessarily win a war but because they do not want to find out. The Great Khan's legal code governing succession was never finished, and no one agrees whether that was an accident.

Dwarves (The Free Holds).

Population approximately 185,000. Governed by an anarcho-syndicalist labor federation -- the Free Holds of Stone -- with no central authority beyond the guild assemblies that govern each individual hold. Lifespan 300-500 years. Deeply isolationist: holds do not open to outsiders, surface trade occurs on a defined schedule at specific contact points, and the empire's attempt to establish a military presence at the mountain approach has been met with silence for twenty years. Their motto is not diplomatic, but it is precise: labor belongs to those who give it, stone belongs to those who work it.

Gnomes (The Collective).

Population approximately 340,000. Governed by a collectivist industrial state based on the eastern islands, with Mechspire as the capital and Clockwork Harbor as the primary continental contact point. Lifespan 200-350 years. The Collective has been withdrawing from mainland contact since Year 120 and maintains exactly as much mainland presence as serves their intelligence requirements. They have assessed the Holy Dominion as a terminal failure state since Year 120 and have been acting on that assessment quietly ever since. Their Phase Three contingency plan has been updated within living memory; the council members who voted on the update will not say what changed.

Goblins (The Resistance).

Population unknown. No central government -- the resistance is organized into cells of 5-20 with no central command, no headquarters, and no permanent leadership. Lifespan 30-60 years, which means the resistance sustains itself through rigorous oral tradition: each generation teaches the names of what was taken and everything attached to those names. The resistance has been an active guerrilla network for 500 years. The empire calls this pest control. The goblins do not expect their children to win; they expect their children to remember long enough that one generation eventually does.

Lizard Folk (The Sects).

Population approximately 15,000 surface-visible; total unknown. Not governed as a single entity -- organized into secretive knowledge sects (Trade Routes, Astronomy, Burial Rites, and others) that share information through private networks. Lifespan 600-800 years, making them the longest-lived surface race. They migrated from the Subterranean Seas five millennia ago and maintain underground connections through hidden river systems. They know things about the Rift's history that predate every other race's surface presence. They say very little and are always specific when they say it.

Cat Folk / Beast Folk (The Diaspora).

Population approximately 45,000. Stateless. No territory, no government, no recognized legal standing in imperial courts. Lifespan 60-80 years. The diaspora moves through desert trade routes and gambling towns, conducting commerce, gathering intelligence, and maintaining their own legal traditions through the Salt Court -- an annual gathering that the empire does not know about and that has been meeting for at least 200 years. The documentation

system marks them and goblins as the highest-risk categories for what the empire calls "processing irregularities." They carry multiple copies of their papers because they expect confiscation.

Geography

The Holy Dominion

occupies the central plains of the continent -- temperate farmland, cathedral cities, fortified roads, and the largest contiguous settled territory on the map. The Cathedral District in the interior is where the Rift's wound is located. The empire has not publicly acknowledged this.

The Elven South

is a dense forest region southeast of the Dominion heartlands. Administered by the elven bureaucratic caste. Towering trees, ley-line nodes, and magical academies exist alongside a population that processes imperial paperwork and keeps copies of everything.

The Dwarven Mountains

run across the north. The holds are entirely underground; what the surface shows is rock face, cave entrances, and the specific trade contact points where dwarves emerge on their schedule. The empire has been trying to establish a formal presence at the mountain approach for twenty years. The dwarves have not responded.

The Orcish Steppes

cover the west -- rolling grassland suited for horse culture, tent cities, and mounted warfare. The clan confederation moves seasonally. Imperial monitoring classifies the larger encampments as "compliant seasonal settlements," which misses approximately everything.

The Gnomish Isles

lie far to the east, past the Silver Seas. Clockwork Harbor is the port city; Mechspire is the capital further inland. Access by outsiders requires permits that are almost always denied. The mainland presence at Windtrap Station processes permit applications and sends most of them back.

Shadowfen

is a dense swamp in the southwest, classified by the empire as "uninhabitable exclusion zone." Thousands of people live here. The Shadow Fen Commune shelters refugees, unsanctioned mages, and anyone who cannot exist under imperial documentation. It is protected by the Veil -- a field of concentrated refugee magic reinforced by infernal pacts. Imperial maps show it as unpassable swamp. The infernal pacts are real and the empire is aware of them and prefers not to acknowledge what that implies.

The Wastes of Calidar

begin south of the Elven South and extend deep into the southern continent. Year 0 turned Calidar's forests to glass: vitrified trees, boiled rivers, melted stone. The interior is genuinely uninhabitable -- no life, no water, no shelter. The border draws scavengers pulled by residual magical energy. Return is forbidden by imperial decree. Every elf alive carries this place in cultural memory. The oldest elves speak of it in the present tense.

The Great Endless Desert

covers the central-south interior. Ancient sand tombs, buried cities, and the remnants of pre-war civilizations. The lizardfolk Astronomy Sect maintains hidden observation stations here, including the Coldwatch observatory -- surface

ruins that imperial cartographers record as pre-war astronomical instruments, which is correct, but the observatory below is still in use.

The Scorched Sands

lie to the west, a volcanic desert with lava tubes, obsidian flows, and mineral deposits. Distinct from the Wastes of Calidar -- naturally hostile terrain, not the result of a weapon. Some orcish clans use the fringes for ritual trials. The goblin tunnel network at Redcap Junction runs directly under an imperial checkpoint that has been standing over it for sixty years.

The Frostbound Reach

is the far north -- tundra, ice, and very few settlements. The gnomish survey network extends here; the furthest observational station watches the continent from above the desert's northern edge.

Key Institutions

The Luminary Inquest

is the Holy Dominion's magical enforcement arm, founded Year 1 alongside the magic ban. It hunts unsanctioned mages, conducts documentation checks, and has execution authority. Its classified records contain 38 Hollowed cases from Years 480-500, all listed as "acute Inquest intervention," filed under a category designation that corresponds to nothing in the official Inquest taxonomy. A moderate faction within the Inquest has existed since approximately Year 300, arguing that enforcement scope has expanded beyond the original mandate. The Veiled Hand is currently divided on whether a more restrained Inquest is preferable to a cruel one that generates its own opposition.

The Veiled Hand

is a compartmentalized assassination network founded in Year 1 by the lizardfolk Astronomy Sect. Its mandate is anti-escalation: the deliberate removal of individuals whose plans, if enacted, would cause mass atrocity. It does not have ranks -- it has roles. Informants know only their territory. Operatives know only their current target. The founding sect knows only what it must. Its operations are documented in death records as accidents, heart failure, and natural causes. The empire's internal pattern recognition reached a threshold in Year 483 that would have required official acknowledgment; no official was willing to provide it. The Veiled Hand is the organizational ancestor of the Adventure Guild's compartmentalized documentation practices.

The Adventure Guild

was formally founded in Year 600, built on the Veiled Hand's organizational model but public-facing in a way the Veiled Hand never was. Its stated purpose is documentation and containment of the Rift. It maintains ten anchor towns as operational bases, a rank system from Stone to Relic, and the only cross-racial institutional structure that all eight races have signed onto. The Holy Dominion signed the Guild's founding compact under protest and has been trying to assert oversight authority ever since. The Guild's charter is clear that no single government has that authority. This has not resolved the tension.

The Imperial Documentation System

is not an institution in the formal sense -- it is the mechanism through which the empire defines who exists and on what terms. Every resident of the Dominion requires papers. Paper renewal cycles differ by race: humans renew every five years, elves every twenty, orcs every three, goblins every year, and cat folk every six months. Papers can be confiscated. Records can be reclassified. A person whose file is marked "pending review" is in legal limbo with no recourse. The elves who administer this system know where the vulnerabilities are and exploit them quietly: certain files

disappear, certain renewals are processed under the wrong category, certain travelers are recorded as having "returned to origin" when they did not.

Major Mysteries

Heaven's Atlas -- Location Unknown.

The weapon that ended the Last World War has not been found in 847 years. The gnomish Survey Station 3 has been specifically watching for its energetic signature since Year 480 with instruments calibrated to detect it. They have not detected it. The gnomish assessment: it may be destroyed, hidden, degraded below detection threshold, or shielded. The "shielded" contingency triggers their Phase Three plan, the contents of which no non-gnome has ever learned.

The Rift's True Nature.

The prevailing assumption is that Heaven's Atlas tore the Rift open when it destroyed Calidar. This is not true. The lizardfolk Astronomy Sect's celestial records from Year 0 show the Atlas activation partially tore a boundary that was already weakened. Goblin oral tradition preserves accounts of the ground near what is now the Cathedral District being "wrong" in the centuries before the war -- sounds that ground should not make, animals that avoided it, children who had unusual dreams. The Rift predates Heaven's Atlas. The Atlas gave the wound a fixed address. It may have prevented the wound from migrating, as the First Confluence did. This information is the Rift Compact's most important unanswered question, and the goblins have been carrying the answer for 800 years.

The Seventh Stone at the Pact Stones.

Seven stone markers at the border of Scorched Sands, Shadowfen, and the Elven South. Six bear the seals of known factions. The seventh belongs to no living group. The elves say it predates Calidar. The lizardfolk say it was there before they started counting. Every agreement made at this circle has held. Every agreement made elsewhere between these factions has eventually failed. The stone appears to produce resonance during Bleed events -- not the Rift's resonance, something older. It is a marker from the civilization that died in the First Confluence. It is, functionally, a warning that nobody left alive could read.

The Gnomish Phase Three Contingency.

The Collective has a three-phase plan for different Heaven's Atlas scenarios. Phase one is ongoing surveillance. Phase two triggers on Atlas detection and involves full withdrawal and sealed harbors. Phase three is described only as "implemented at council discretion." It was updated by unanimous vote at a recent council session. Three council members who would have opposed the original version were reassigned before the vote that established it. The trade representative Kelva, the closest non-gnome has ever come to the production councils, knows the plan exists and knows this much about its history. She does not know what it does.

The Great Khan's Unfinished Law.

The Great Khan died 847 years ago with a succession clause unfinished mid-sentence. Without it, no new Khan can be legitimately named under the legal code every orc recognizes. One living witness says the Khan put down the pen deliberately. The other says he collapsed from a seizure that had been building for months. Both are over 300 years old. Neither is lying. A third witness who might have settled the question died at age 310 -- notable for a race that typically lives to 500 -- seventeen years ago, in the same year the Veiled Hand deployed an operative to the steppes for a sealed "witness assessment" mission. The empire knows about the unfinished clause. They benefit from its ambiguity. The Veiled Hand may have created that ambiguity deliberately, on the grounds that a unified Khanate is an existential risk to the stability that prevents a third World War.

The Hollowed in the Imperial Capital.

The transformation into a Hollowed requires the consumption of one's own kind. In a surveillance state with comprehensive documentation, this should be detectable. The Inquest's classified records from Years 480-500 document 38 cases in the capital and surrounding provinces where individuals showed behavioral change over months, dietary records showed irregularities, and the individuals were subsequently executed. All 38 cases are filed under a designation that does not correspond to any known Inquest category. The file designation is "Yr'shalos Adjacent." The investigation appears to have stopped when it reached a specific building in the administrative district. No record explains why.

Anchor Towns

Town	Race	Zone ID	Key Feature
The Holy Dominion	Human (starter)	starter_town	Fortified cathedral town; the Rift's closest surface access; political and religious entry point for the empire
Solara	Human (capital)	solara	
Sylvaris	Elf	sylvaris	Forest canopy city in the Elven South; center of elven administrative operations and cultural preservation
Ironhold	Dwarf	ironhold	Underground forge-city; the Free Holds' largest surface-adjacent hold; does
Kragmor	Orc	kragmor	Scattered town; largest permanent orcish settlement; monitored closely by imperial intelligence
BoneTrap	Goblin	bonetrap	Hidden warren in the steppes borderlands; decentralized resistance hub; outsiders are
Murkmire	Lizard Folk	murkmire	Along the waterline: the Shadow Fen Commune's largest gathering point, mixed-race, on stilts; below the waterline: a liz
Mechspire	Gnome	mechspire	Clockwork industrial capital on the eastern islands; primary seat of the Collective's production councils
Clockwork Harbor	Gnome (port)	clockwork_harbor_town	

Fortune's Rest	Cat Folk	fortunes_rest	Desert oasis settlement; gambling dens, trade caravans, and the closest thing the diaspora has to a fixed home
----------------	----------	---------------	--

The Rift

The Rift is a wound in the ground near the Holy Dominion's Cathedral District -- a tear in the boundary between the world's surface and what is below it, created by the First Confluence before the Last World War and torn open to a fixed location by Heaven's Atlas at Year 0. It manifests as an infinite dungeon that reseeds daily at midnight, managed since Year 600 by the Adventure Guild, which requires Guild membership and rank advancement to access its deeper floors. The Rift is not a neutral space. It has preferences. Dungeon documentation across 247 years shows that certain individuals descend farther than their skill level predicts, certain races encounter certain floor themes at statistically improbable frequency, and certain days produce configurations that should be random but recur. Warden Grell, the Guild's most significant historical figure, documented in Year 820: "The Rift chose me. I believe this now. I did not believe it in Year 753 when I first noticed the pattern. I believe it now because I have tested the hypothesis systematically and it holds." In Year 800, the Rift produced its first floor that no existing framework could explain. Grell's note on this floor: "The floor knows we are here. This is not metaphor. The floor has preferences. The floor has been waiting."